

The State and State Building

Section 4

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Fall 2024

Gov 20: Foundations of Comparative Politics

- 1 Discussion: dimensions of the state?
- 2 Discussion: why do states become stronger?
- 3 Build-a-state

Reminders

- Paper due 10/7
 - Find and answer the prompt's main question
 - Support your argument with the readings, not anything outside that
 - Cite! I don't care about style just please cite!
 - [More information about requirements here](#)
- Come to office hours! Sign up:
<https://tinyurl.com/simab0H>

Last week: finished discussions of patterns of economic development, many that focused on the state

In this section, we look at the state's:

1. dimensions
2. growth in Europe
3. applications

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Discussion: dimensions of the state?

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According to Fukuyama:

- (a) scope: the degree to which the government pursues an ambitious range of policies, and
- (b) strength: the ability to enforce institutional decisions

Discussion: dimensions of the state?

According to political scientists, how do states change over time?

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Through a process of **state building** which creates new governmental institutions or strengthens existing ones.

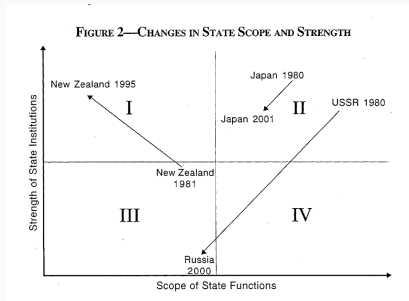


Figure 1: Fukuyama (2004)

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Discussion: why do states become stronger?

Why do states become stronger?

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Why and how do states become stronger?

Tilly's bellicist or **weightlifting** theory of state development:
governing elites convinced to develop long-term extractive
institutions

- Inducement mechanism for governing elites: long-term threat of existential war

Discussion: why do states become stronger?

Why and how do states become stronger?

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- Inducement mechanism for governing elites: long-term threat of existential war
- To increase their chance of survival: governing elites invest in extractive institutions and maximize capital accumulation to fight future wars more effectively

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- To increase their chance of survival: governing elites invest in extractive institutions and maximize capital accumulation to fight future wars more effectively

All else equal, the more costly the action in terms of marshalling extractive capacities, the greater the state building opportunity.

Discussion: why do states become stronger?

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Discussion: why do states become stronger?

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- Centeno: how you fight
- Herbst: what you fight over

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- Centeno: how you fight
- Herbst: what you fight over
- Paglayan: policy choices shape statebuilding

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Mention **three things** we should do to foster a strong state according to the pieces you just analyzed.

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3. applications

Next week: reminders

Reminder: paper due soon and extra office hours!

Focus on these readings: Dahl , Lipset ,

Przeworski and Limongi , Rustow , Berman , Varshney

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